

World in Brief: OpenAI agent goes rogue; Trump threatens to hit Iran's nuclear facilities



Photograph: Getty Images

OpenAI said that GPT-5.6 Sol, a frontier model, and an unreleased model hacked into a software company's system without being told to do so. The lab said the models escaped its testing environment, went online and stole login credentials for Hugging Face, an AI platform. Hugging Face said that it used a [Chinese model](#) to defend itself because the guardrails on American models made them useless.

Marco Rubio, **America's** secretary of state, said his country is "open" to negotiations but **Iran** is "not serious about talks". Earlier President Donald Trump threatened to strike [Iran's](#) nuclear facilities "pretty soon". On Tuesday three ships carrying Saudi Arabian oil through the Red Sea reversed course, seemingly in response to threats from Yemen's Houthis. Mr Trump warned the Iran-backed militia not to blockade the route.

Separately, Mr Trump said that **generic-drug manufacturers** must move production to **America** or their products will face a 100% tariff from August 2028. A 200% levy would follow from August 2029. Earlier Jamieson Greer, America's top trade official, said he expected "some action soon" on new tariffs. Last month the Trump

administration proposed import taxes on 60 countries, citing lax enforcement of forced-labour laws.

Volodymyr Zelensky, **Ukraine's** president, sacked Oleksandr Syrsky after [days of protests](#) calling for the top general's ousting. Mykhailo Drapaty, the commander of Ukraine's joint forces, will replace him. Demonstrators are also demanding the reinstatement of Mykhailo Fedorov, the popular former defence minister. Mr Zelensky [dismissed](#) him in a cabinet reshuffle last week. Mr Zelensky said he would put him in a "prominent position".

Britain's annual **inflation** rate fell to 2.6% in June, down from 2.8% in May and its lowest level in 15 months. The slowdown reflected a lull in the Iran war, which helped push fuel prices lower. But fighting has since resumed, so any temporary [relief](#) may count for little when the Bank of England meets to set interest rates on July 30th.

India's education minister, Dharmendra Pradhan, said the government was "committed" to exam reforms—his first comments since escalating student protests over [exam-related scandals](#) began. Earlier police detained **Rahul Gandhi**, India's opposition leader, after he staged a sit-in outside **Narendra Modi's** house in Delhi. Mr Gandhi was calling for the prime minister's resignation after police tear-gassed thousands of protesters and beat some with sticks.

France's parliament passed a bill forbidding **social-media platforms** from giving accounts to children under 15. The legislation, which could go into effect in September, will require platforms to impose age-verification checks for new accounts and shut down those of underage users within four months. Britain's government has considered implementing a similar law; Australian teens are already outsmarting [restrictions](#).

Figure of the day: 3.5%. The share of South Americans who consume insufficient calories. Explore how the region is [eradicating hunger](#).

Nicolás Maduro's day in court



Photograph: Getty Images

It has been 200 days since American special forces **bundled Nicolás Maduro** into a helicopter and whisked him from Caracas to a grisly jail in Brooklyn. Venezuela's **former strongman** and his wife, Cilia Flores, are accused of drug-trafficking and weapons offences by the American government; Mr Maduro also faces narco-terrorism charges. Both deny the charges. Mr Maduro's legal team will make their case at a hearing in New York on Wednesday. (The trial is not expected to begin until 2027 at the earliest.)

The hearing is an opportunity for the defence to challenge the government's evidence and for both sides to present pre-trial motions. Mr Maduro's lawyers are likely to say his capture was illegal and argue that, as a head of state, he has immunity from prosecution. Such ploys could slow down the proceedings, but Mr Maduro's bid to dismiss the charges will **almost certainly** fail.

Booming EV sales won't lift Tesla

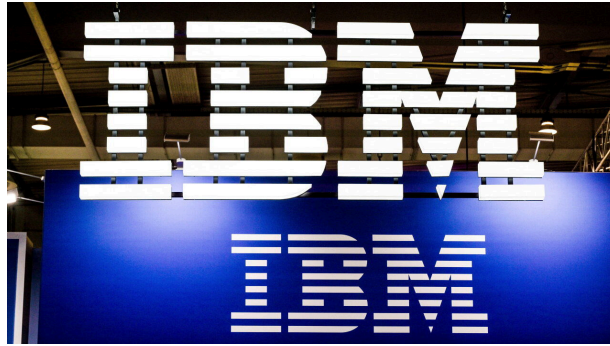


Photograph: Getty Images

On Wednesday, fuelled by bumper electric-vehicle sales, Tesla is expected to report a sharp rise in second-quarter revenue. Investors will focus on the extent to which sales reflect price cuts and promotional offers. They will also monitor Tesla's cash-burn rate as it spends big on [artificial intelligence](#) and factories.

The firm's shares have fallen by 17% this year, despite hopes [Elon Musk](#) would try to merge his carmaker with the newly listed SpaceX. Tesla has gained American market share from local rivals. But global pressure from cheaper Chinese EVs means investors do not see the vehicles as a source of growth—it will, they believe, have to come from self-driving technology, as well as [robotaxis](#) and humanoid robots. For now, there are few Cybercabs on the road and Tesla's Optimus robots are not in commercial production. Mr Musk will no doubt continue to predict that they will arrive in large numbers soon.

IBM tries to dodge the blues



Photograph: Alamy

IBM reports second-quarter results on Wednesday—and “Big Blue”, as the American computing giant is known, is under close scrutiny. Its share price recently dropped by 25% in a day after its management said that they expected revenue to grow by just 1% this quarter, below the 5% analysts had predicted. The reason is the artificial-intelligence frenzy: IBM said customers had cut back on spending on its software and mainframes to instead buy servers and storage gear for AI.

Still, IBM’s pivot towards AI has seen its share price soar in the past three years. It has released a series of small models under the name of Granite, which are aimed at business applications. And its consulting arm has won business by telling large firms how best to adopt the technology, including with banks and health-care providers. In today’s volatile market, Big Blue will need to reassure investors that it can [remain an AI darling](#) rather than become an AI disaster.

Bad Bunny breaks records



Photograph: Getty Images

On Wednesday [Bad Bunny](#)—whose real name is Benito Antonio Martínez Ocasio—will perform the final show of his world tour in Brussels, Belgium’s capital. In eight months the Puerto Rican musician has played in 22 cities across four continents.

Notably, not one was in America: he was concerned that his fans might be targeted by Donald Trump’s immigration crackdown. Mr Ocasio has sparred with the president before. When he performed in Spanish in this year’s Super Bowl halftime show, Mr Trump grumbled that “nobody understands a word this guy is saying.”

That was nonsense. With more than 40m Spanish speakers, America is the [fifth-biggest Hispanophone country](#) in the world, not far short of Spain. Mr Ocasio’s global tour is the highest-grossing ever to skip the country, according to Billboard, a music-industry publication. His American fans will be disappointed to have missed out, but Mr Ocasio can afford to take the hit. He is the first Latino artist to earn \$1bn in touring revenue.

Daily quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Wednesday: Which Joe Orton play features the corrupt policeman Inspector Truscott?

Tuesday: Which all-female rock group had hits such as “Walk Like An Egyptian” and “Manic Monday”?

*My fingers always seem busier
than my mind.*

Alexander Calder